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Linn: Mist Iron

large Raids, Rivers, and Oathbinding (Fate's Edge v0.1)

A culturefocused module for coastal raids, river thrusts, oathlaw, and seasonal expeditions by the Linnsseafarers of the north who strike the Violet Steppe littoral, run the Yloka up into the Abderrian Sea and Mistlands, and range as far south as Theona in the Dolmis. Built to slot into Amaranthine Sea, Political Intrigue, Wilderness, and Caravans using core Fate's Edge procedures (Position/DV, SB, timers, Strings, Favor/Leverage/Exposure).

LargeDesign Goals

tem **Oath before oar.** Social bonds, boasts, and bloodsilver shape play as much as blades. tem **Raidertrader parity.** Raids, mercenary service, and escort trade are equally supported. tem **Seamless integration.** Uses existing chase/ship rules, faction timers, and currenciesno new dice math. tem **Low bookkeeping.** Crew, ship, season wheel, and 23 visible timers per scenario.

ering tionLinn: Mist Iron The First Year (Quickstart) |>eringm2.5cm|>eringm3cm|>eringm4cm|>eri
line gray!20 **Season Key Activities Mechanical Focus Sample Score**

line **Winter Hearth/Thing** Rest, repair, socialize, attend Thing moots

tem Resolve Feuds with BloodSilver tem Swear/fulfill Oaths tem Advance Repute
through deeds

Thing Moot: Settle disputes, gain winter land, swear new oaths

line **Spring Muster** Prepare ships, gather crews, plan summer activities

tem Ship repairs/upgrades tem Crew coordination rolls tem Plan expedition objectives

Scout Mission: Gather intelligence on threats/locations for summer

line **Summer Raids** Active expeditions, trading, warfare

tem Coastal Raid (Plunder/BloodPrice timers) tem River Strike (Pursuit/Current timers) tem Combat encounters tem Weather/Ice hazards

Coastal Raid: Plunder a settlement while evading pursuit

line **Autumn Trade/Settling** Profit from summer deeds, settle accounts

tem Escort/Trade (Market procedures) tem Saga Reputation gains tem Social maneuvering at Thing tem Plan for winter

Escort Mission: Protect trade goods while navigating hazards

line

ering tionCore Quickstart Rules Summary |>eringm3cm|>eringm5cm|>eringm5cm|

line gray!20 **System Quick Rule Key Dice**

line **Crew Tracks** Repute [6]: Fame/standing

Feud [4]: Active quarrels

Exposure [6]: Foreign attention DV 25

Position: Dominant/Controlled/Desperate

Reroll 1 success/failure

line **Ship Actions** Navigate (DV 25)

Board Brace (DV 35)

Chase (Sea/River) (DV 25) Ship Tags modify DVs

Weather/Ice Matrix [46]

line **Oaths Saga** Oath Ledger: Favors owed/held

Break Oath: Repute 1, Feud +1

Saga Reputation [6]: Local → Regional → Legendary Saga Points for epic deeds

Position/Social benefits by tier

line **Complications** Mist Iron SB Menu (14 SB)

Weather/Ice hazards

Fen Corruption timer Story Beats drive narrative

Environmental timers

line

large1 Linn Crew/Clan Sheet (Template)

|p5cm|p5cm| line [CLAN / CREW NAME]

line Aett (home seat):

ThingAffiliation:

line

Strings (23): winter harbor Í ríverright Í trade oath Í feud settlement Í warding chant Í pilot's stone

Tags (24): Oathbound Í Riverwise Í IceTrained Í ReaverKnown Í Hospitable Í LawStrict Í SkaldLoud Í WolfBanner

Tracks:

tem Repute [6] (standing among Linn and neighbors) tem Feud [4] (active quarrel; on fill ß bloodprice owed or war) tem Exposure [6] (to foreign powers; for nonLinn venues)

Oath Ledger: favors owed/held (name + what; acts like Favor/Leverage within Linn spheres)

Notables: steersman Í warleader Í speaker Í skald Í shipwright

Repute [6]: Tick up for kept oaths, fair trade, valor; tick down for oathbreaking, cowardice, or sacrilege. High Repute grants Audience: Respectful at thing; low invites Audience: Skeptical.

Feud [4]: Name the counterparty. Ticks on insult, theft, or harm; clear by bloodsilver, ordeal, or deed.

large2 Ship Sheet (Longhulls Rivercraft)

Pick a hull and 34 tags.

Longhull (raider): shallow draft, fast oars, beachable.

Broadshore (cargo): higher freeboard, stout frames, slower oars.

Riverspear (cutter): light, narrow, collapsible mast for weirs.

Ship Tags (choose 34)

tem Shallow Draft River rapids Drive/Handle DV 1; cross bars, weirs. tem Beaching Hull Land/sail from beaches; Disengage gains Position +1 at surf. tem IceReady In thaw/freeze scenes, first Condition +1 is ignored. tem Mistwise In fog/gares,

Navigate DV 1; Ambush at Sea starts one Position higher. tem RiverRunner Row Upstream DV 1; portage checks Position +1. tem WolfBoarding Gear Board Brace DV 1; entangling hooks/ropes. tem High Shields +1 die defending vs arrows/sling; on 1: SideSlip penalty (windage) applies. tem SkaldDrum Once/score gain Audience: Fierce aboard; can rally morale. tem Pilots' Stones Hidden cairnmarks; once/score Navigate Position +1 in shoals.

Roles (choose at table)

Steersman (helm), WarLeader (boarding/assault), Speaker (parley), Skald (morale/saga), Shorehand (portage/repairs), Lookout (weather/ice).

large3 Season Wheel Theaters

Spring Muster ß Summer Raids ß Autumn Trade/Settling ß Winter Hearth/Thing.

At each transition:

tem Advance Politics (Mandate/Crisis) for coastal powers. tem Roll Weather/Ice [46] for the theater in play (coast, river, mistland). tem Offer Oath Opportunities (escort, feud settlement, shrine warding).

Theaters

tem Coast (Abderrian/Mistlands): cliffs, skerries, tide races, fog. tem River (Yloka): bars, rapids, weirs, tollfords, riverside towns. tem Dolmis Reach (south): broader seas, warmer storms, foreign courts.

large4 Score Types Procedures

Pick approach (Deceit Í Speed Í Shock Í Parley) ß set Position/DV from venue/tags ß roll.

4.1 Coastal Raid (Objective: Plunder / Message / Prisoner)

Timers: Alarm [46], Plunder [68], Ship Damage [4], BloodPrice [4].

Entry: surf landing, hidden cove, tide gate, harbor ruse.

On 1s: GM spends SB ß alarm bells, hidden shoal, torchchain across channel, watch-tower signal.

Resolution: When Plunder fills, choose coin or Strings (hostage pledge, toll writ, seasonal tithe). If BloodPrice fills, mark Feud +1 or pay bloodsilver (Favor loss or obligation timer).

4.2 River Strike (Objective: Tollhouse / Weir / Rival Barge)

Timers: Current [4], Pursuit [6], Sentries [4], Plunder/Terms [6].

Position tweaks: RiverRunner/Shallow Draft help; crosswinds/hail hurt.

On 1s: weir gets raised, arrows from reedblind, boomchain snaps at wrong time.

4.3 Escort/Trade (Objective: Profit / Standing)

Use Market from Amaranthine/Caravans; add Linn perks:

tem Thing Tokens (oathmarkers) count as String once/session in Linn venues. tem SkaldDrum can convert Audience: Warm ß Favor (narrow) once/score with a saga.

4.4 Thing Moot (Objective: Law / Settlement)

Venue: ring of stones, winter hall.

Moves: OathSwear (commit under penalty), Wager Wyrð (ordeal by feat), BloodSilver (compensation roll), Witness the Saga (Skald stakes a truth).

Outcomes: resolve Feud, write Oath to ledger (acts as durable String), assign winter land or riverright.

large5 Oaths, BloodSilver, Repute

tem **Oath (currency):** Inside Linn spheres, treat Oath Ledger entries as Favor/Leverage equivalents; breaking one ticks Repute 1 and creates Feud +1. tem **BloodSilver (settlement):** Pay with coin, hostage string, or deed. Roll Petition/Broker vs DV 24 (standing, witnesses, hurt). On hit, reduce Feud 2; on partial, 1; on miss, counter-oath demanded. tem **Boasts Sagas:** A public boast creates Audience: Expectant; fulfill it to gain Repute +1, fail and mark Exposure or Feud.

large6 Sea River Procedures

6.1 DV Ladders

tem **Chase (Sea)**: DV 2 reach Ł 3 skerries Ł 4 reef line Ł 5 storm eddies. tem **Chase (River)**: DV 2 open Ł 3 bars Ł 4 rapids Ł 5 weirs/locks. tem **Board Brace**: DV 35 (tags: WolfBoarding Gear lowers DV).

6.2 Weather/Ice Matrix [46]

Advance on 1s or fiction:

tem **Fog/Mist**: sight Position 1; Mistwise cancels. On 1, Pursuit +1 (lost bearings). tem **Squall/Hail**: ranged actions 1 die; on 1, Condition +1 (sails/rig). tem **Ice/Floe**: Navigate DV +1; on 1, choose Delay (Distance stalls) or KeelScuff (Condition +1).

6.3 Portage Weirs

Treat as Cross Hazard (Body+Tactics/Craft) DV 35; RiverRunner/Shallow Draft grant Position +1. On 1, Oarline snaps or Axlesled breaks.

6.4 Mist Iron SB (GM menu)

tem Hidden Shoal: sudden ground; Ship Damage +1 unless Position was high. tem Tower Fire: beacon lit; Pursuit +1 and Alarm +1. tem Oarline Breaks: lose Position; repair or fight shorthanded. tem Witness at Cliff: an enemy skiff sees; Exposure +1 (foreign) or Feud +1 (Linn). tem Saga Twisted: rumor flips an Audience tag against you.

large7 Linn Culture Tools (portrayal guidance)

tem Emphasize law and reciprocity (oaths, bloodsilver, witness) over caricature. tem Show plural livelihoods: fishers, traders, wardens, mercenaries, skaldsnot only raiders. tem Let women/elders hold seats and steer deals; avoid monolith tropes. tem Lean into seasonality and thing assemblies as civic life.

Etiquette Hooks (once/scene in Linn venues): gift the host's hearth with salt/fish oil; name your mother's line; offer a verse each can grant Position +1 in parley.

large8 Factions Fronts

tem **Linns Union (docks dues):** Stringsdock priority, barge pilots. tem **Mistland Wardens:** Stringsfog bell chains, cliff beacons. tem **Yloka Tollmen:** Stringsboomchains, river seals. tem **Dolmis Factors:** Stringswinter contracts, bonded warehouses. tem **Shrine of StormWhale:** Stringssaferun chants, tithe.

Front Timers (examples):

tem Reprisals Fleet [68] (coastal power organizes counterstrike). tem Thing Schism [6] (oath controversies split halls). tem Mistland Famine [6] (trade mission needed; gain Standing if solved).

large9 Generators

9.1 Coastal Targets (d66)

11 tide mill 12 beacon tower 13 cliff monastery 14 saltworks 15 fishing fleet 16 lord's boathouse 21 skerry storehouse 22 ropewalk 23 ferrychain 24 dyeshed 25 customs shed 26 river gate 31 amber beach 32 quarry pier 33 seal rookery 36 barge yard 35 sheep isle 36 fortress quay 41 smokehouse row 42 eelweirs 43 pilot stone 44 winter harbor 45 tax sloop 46 river lighthouse 51 shrine cove 52 smugglers' cut 53 patrol launch 54 tollhouse 55 grain pier 56 seawall breach 61 ice slip 62 wreckers' fires 63 tide cave 64 chain boom 65 slate wharf 66 mint barge.

9.2 River Hazards (d12)

1 bar on a bend 2 sudden freshet 3 weir ratlines 4 deadwood snag 5 eelpots 6 ice pans 7 hidden sidecut 8 bluff echo 9 toll chain half-raised 10 reeds conceal archers 11 rainswollen ford 12 sandsuck bank.

9.3 Thing Cases (d12)

1 insult in song 2 stolen pilot stone 3 broken oath on winter grain 4 bloodprice disputed 5 marriage claim 6 warding chant stolen 7 hostage pledge lapsed 8 salvage rights 9 border cairn moved 10 feud cooling terms 11 saga witness contest 12 mercenary pay withheld.

9.4 Sagas Boons (d12)

1 oarsong that steadies arms 2 whale omen at dawn 3 amber find 4 pilot's ghost shows a cut 5 stormwhale spares you 6 omen of red sails 7 skald's verse spreads 8 winter hall adopts you 9 river seal renewed 10 cliff bell silent 11 mist opens path 12 oathring warms (truth told).

10 Integration Notes

tem **Amaranthine Sea:** Use ship chase and blockade tools; Linn SkaldDrum converts Audience to Favor once/score in port riots or dock disputes. tem **Caravans:** Swap staging at waystations with winter harbors; RiverRunner aids barge convoys upriver. tem **Wilderness:** Portage/overland jumps tie into outpost assets; fjord hunts use Hunt/Chase ladders. tem **Political Intrigue:** Treat the Thing as a political venue; Repute sets default Position; BloodSilver interacts with Favor/Exposure economies. tem **Psionics:** Seers translate as omenreaders; allow Psychic Weather Sense to soften fog/ice penalties once/leg. tem **Dragon's Lair:** Skerries and glacier valleys hide wyrm shrines; oaths may bind to ancient powers for perilous boons.

11 Example of Play (short)

Setup: Longhull with Shallow Draft, Mistwise, WolfBoarding Gear. Crew Repute 3/6, Feud 1/4 (with Yloka Tollmen). Score: River Strike against a boomchain tollhouse (Plunder/Terms).

Approach: ParleythenShock. Speaker petitions for winter discount (DV 3). Partial ß Position stays Controlled, GM spends 1 SB.

Action: WarLeader triggers Board Brace at the boom. WolfBoarding Gear drops DV to 3. Hit ß Plunder +2; a 1 shows ß GM spends Tower Fire (Alarm +1, Pursuit +1).

Twist: Fog rolls in. Mistwise cancels Position penalty. Steersman runs a Pilots' Stone line: Navigate gains Position +1; Pursuit 1.

Close: Plunder fills. Crew chooses a seasonal tithe String instead of coin. BloodPrice at 2/4; they pledge bloodsilver at winter thing to avoid Feud tick.

large12 GM Reference (one page)

tem **Crew:** Repute [6] Ó Feud [4] Ó Exposure [6] Ó Oath Ledger. tem **Ships:** choose hull + 34 tags. Roles: Steersman Ó WarLeader Ó Speaker Ó Skald Ó Shorehand Ó Lookout. tem **Season Wheel:** Spring muster Ó Summer raids Ó Autumn trade/settle Ó Winter thing. tem **Score Types:** Coastal Raid Ó River Strike Ó Escort/Trade Ó Thing Moot. tem **Key Timers:** Alarm Ó Plunder Ó Ship Damage Ó BloodPrice Ó Pursuit. tem **Weather/Ice:** Fog/Mist Ó Squall/Hail Ó Ice/Floe. tem **SB Menu:** Hidden Shoal Ó Tower Fire Ó Oarline Breaks Ó Witness at Cliff Ó Saga Twisted. tem **Integration:** Portage Wilderness Ó Dock riots Amaranthine Ó Thing Political Ó Omens Psionics.

large13 Changelog

v0.1 First draft: crew/ship sheets, tags roles, season wheel, sea/river procedures, raid/river/thing scores, oath bloodsilver economy, generators, integration, and an example.

End of v0.1

Hunger in the Mist

Large A Linn Adventure for Fate's Edge (v0.1)

Hunger in the Mist

Large A Linn Adventure for Fate's Edge (v0.1)

A coastal-river saga for Tier IIII parties, inspired by northern raiding epics and survival horrorreimagined for Fate's Edge without referencing any specific IP. Built to slot into Linn: Mist Iron, Wilderness, Caravans, Amaranthine Sea, Political Intrigue, and Psionics.

Pitch

Winter's edge bites the Mistlands. Beacon towers fail. Villages whisper of FogHarrier-santlerhelmed raiders who strike from fen and chalk caves, leaving carrion totems and vanished kin. The Linn hall of Stenskar seals its doors... then sends for help. The omens demand a mixed company: oarsmen and outsiders together, for the mist does not remember one tongue alone.

Play in 35 sessions: defend a hall; scout the black fen; unmask the Harriers; strike the warrens; end a broodline at dawn.

Safety Tone

tem Horror and funerary imagery; keep consent tools handy. tem Keep Linn culture plural: traders, fishers, skalds, wardensnot caricature raiders. tem The FogHarriers are a syncretic cult of coastal and fen folk (not a "lost people" stereotype). Their practices are ritual, not racial.

What You Need

tem Fate's Edge core SRD (Position/DV, SB, timers, Strings). tem Linn: Mist Iron (crew/ship tags, thing, oaths, sea/river ladders). tem Wilderness (camp, biomes: marsh/coast). Optional: Psionics (omens), Political (thing moot), Caravans/Sea if you bring escort/convoy play.

large14 Cast Hooks

PC hooks (choose or invent):

tem Outsider Envoy from a southern city bearing a winter contract. tem SkaldLoud: your saga named a fen spirit; it answered. tem Mistland Warden: your bellchain went silent; your oath binds you to find why. tem River Pilot: your pilot stones were moved; trade boats vanish. tem Noetic Adept (Psionics): your dreams taste of chalk and marrow; omens point north.

Notables

tem Jarl Arnhild Stenskar (Speaker at winter thing). Strings: winter harbor, feud settlement. tem Hevr Skarn (WarLeader). String: oaroad. tem Friga of the Bell Chain (Warden). String: beacon rites. tem The FogHarriers (cult). Strings: bog totems, whisper warrens, marrow resin. tem The BroodMatron (Harrier oracle). String: bone throne in the chalk deeps.

large15 Fronts Timers

Primary front Hunger in the Mist

tem Beacon Silence [6] as it fills, coastal beacons fail; +1 Position to Harrier night strikes. tem Missing Boats [6] trade collapses; famine pressure rises. tem BroodMatron's Rite [8] completes a mass anointing; Harriers fight at +1 Effect at night.

Local timers

tem Hall Panic [6] rumor and grief; insert disadvantage tags until calmed. tem Feud with Tollmen [4] complicates river help; clear at thing or pay bloodsilver. tem Oath Debts [4] favors owed by Stenskar; cash for aid or betrayal.

large16 Adventure Structure

16.1 Act I The Hall at Dusk (Defense Oaths)

Scene A1: River Arrival

tem Enter by longhull or barge under fog. Mistwise helps; otherwise Position 1 to Navigate. tem Encounter: wreckers' fires lure boats to a shoal (Hidden Shoal SB). Rescue or lose supplies.

Scene A2: Stenskar Winter Hall

tem A funeral table, skalds quiet, children hidden. Hall Panic [6] starts at 2/6. tem Thinglet: a small moot in the hall: testimonies about antler masks and bogincense. tem Oath: Arnhild swears guestright and asks for a mixed company. Add OarOath String: one boon per session on a roll taken in public defense of Stenskar.

Scene A3: Night Probe

tem Harriers test the palisade with bone rattles and peatsmoke. Use Board Brace if defending the river gate; ranged volleys are hampered by fog. tem On any 1, spend SB Witness at Cliff (enemy skiff sees you); tick Missing Boats +1.

Outcomes: stabilize Hall Panic, earn Beacon Rite String (Warden's trust), discover marrow resin (sweet narcotic used by Harriers).

16.2 Act II Black Fen Recon (Scouting Skirmish)

Travel: Wilderness Marsh biome; set Distance [6], Danger [4], Weather [4: fog/rain].

Intent: Scout or Hide to reduce Sign.

Key Sites

tem Bell Chain 7: rope cut, bell stolen; recover clapper for Clue. tem Totem Isle: antler totems, peatfires burning cold; a captive left as bait. tem Pilot Stone Cairn: moved downstream; reset to ease escape later (Position +1 on retreat). tem Fen Bear's Den: optional hunt; pelt as leverage at thing.

Encounters

tem Harrier Skirmishers (Near): reedmasks, bone darts (Harm 1, poison tag Drowse → Weariness +1). tem BogHaze: Weather tick; on 1, Condition +1 unless Shelter tag. tem Whisper Caves Mouth: chalk dust, singing vents; enter now or return prepared.

Objectives

tem Track the Harriers to the warrens (accumulate 3 Clues: totem analysis, captive interrogation, resin tracing). tem Seize totems/resin to learn their rite. tem Optionally bargain at riverside Thing to clear Feud with Tollmen.

16.3 Act III The Whisper Warrens (Assault Choice)

Dungeon Frame: single timer Warrens Depth [8]; three spokes: Bone Gallery, Steam Vents, Brood Halls. Advance on noise, heat, or delay. Harriers get Position +1 in darkness unless PCs carry warding light.

Rooms Beats

tem Bone Gallery: trophy totems; a riddlesong carved in chalk (Insight DV 3 decodes entry order; on 1, Alarm [4] +1). tem Steam Vents: scalding fog bursts; Cross Hazard DV 34. tem Brood Halls: sleeping pits; marrow resin harvest; captives. Mercy vs Zeal choice: rescue captives (slows assault, gain 1 Boon) or leave them (assault faster, Harriers fight with +1 Effect until BroodMatron's Rite is reduced).

The BroodMatron

tem Oraclechieftain enthroned on jointed bone. Uses Drowse fumes, reedpipes to coordinate, and antler staff to parry. tem Moves: Frenzy the Pack (allies gain +1 Effect for one exchange), Fog Veil (Position 1 for intruders), Marrow Breath (Weariness +1 area; SB spend). tem Strings: prophecy tokens (chalk sticks carved with tide glyphs) and a Bone Oath Ring that can settle Feud at a Thing if claimed.

Finale Options

tem Strike the Matron: break the cult's coordination; Harriers fragment. tem Collapse the Vents: explosives or psionic overpressure to seal the warrens (Weather +1; retreat timer). tem Parley of Oaths: prove the Matron bent an ancient river oath; some Harriers stand down under witness.

Aftermath: if BroodMatron's Rite was near full, pockets of Harriers fight on at night until Beacon Silence is restored.

large17 Running the FogHarriers

They are human cultists. Their horror comes from ritual masks, peatsmoke tactics, and night discipline, not species. Frame them as a fen syncretic sect that fed on famine and

fear. Some defect when confronted with oaths and proofs.

Harrier Types (framework)

tem Skirmisher: reed mask, bone darts (Near), marsh knife (Close). Tags: Drowse, Reedslip (Hide/Disengage Position +1 in marsh). DV: 3 for ranged, 2 for melee. tem Reaver: antler helm, hooked spear (Close), net (entangle). Tag: Hook Haul (on hit, reposition foe). DV: 2 for melee. tem Whisperer: smokerunner, pipesignals, resin flasks. Move: Fog Veil (once/scene Position 1 to ranged against allies). DV: 2. tem BroodMatron: see above. DV: 4, Harm 2.

Use core opposition building: set DV by venue/cover (marsh, fog, night), hand out SB on 1s, and lean on Reedslip/Hook Haul to shape the fight.

large18 Oaths, Law, Thing

tem A Hall Thinglet can grant Witness for an oath; use it to settle Feud with Tollmen or bind local aid. tem Blood-Silver converts one Feud tick into truce; Boast publicly and fulfill it to gain Repute +1 at winter thing. tem The Bone Oath Ring from the warrens is admissible proof at a Thing; returning it can grant Standing with Mistland Wardens.

large19 Wilderness Travel Procedures

tem Marsh Biome: Infiltrate Position +1; Drive Position 1. Hazards: sucking mud (Cross DV 35), miasma (Weariness +1 + Sickness [4]), hidden channel (Swim/Boat). tem Weather Matrix (Fog/Rain/Ice): see Wilderness; fog adds Pursuit +1 on 1s unless Mistwise.

Sample Leg: Stenskar → Black Fen Mouth (Distance [4], Danger [4], Weather [4: fog]). Intent Hide. On strong Hide Sign, reduce Sign 2; on 1, Witness at Cliff SB.

large20 Sea River Hooks

tem River Strike: sabotage boom-chains raising for Harrier skiffs (Pursuit/Current timers). tem Escort: run refugees or grain; Skald-Drum can convert Audience: Warm

→ Favor at a desperate dock. tem Ambush at Sea: Harrier cutters use kelp curtains; Mistwise counters.

large21 Psionics Hooks (optional)

tem Dream Weather: Noetic PC senses chalk singing → Clue to vent map; reduce Warrens Depth advance once. tem Aegis of Will: disperse dart volleys (convert Harm 1 → Fatigue). tem Foresight: warn of a night probe; set Hall Defense Position +1.

large22 Rewards Fallout

Strings: Beacon Rites • Bone Oath Ring • Winter Harbor • Pilot's Stones Reset • Tollmen Truce.

Boons: Mist opens path (Position +1 on a fog scene once) • Skald's Verse spreads (Audience: Warm on arrival).

Standing: with Mistland Wardens, Dock unions, or Linn thing.

Treasure: marrow resin (contraband), antler crafts, river seals, captives ransomed.

Campaign Ripples:

tem The marrow resin points to a southern buyer → city or sea arc. tem The Bone Oath Ring ties to an ancient river oath → political arc. tem The chalk vents hint at wyrm channels → dragon arc.

large23 Prep Aids

Visible timers to start: Beacon Silence 2/6 • Missing Boats 1/6 • Hall Panic 2/6.

Handouts: Oath tokens, totem sketches, bell-chain map, pilot stones diagram.

Music: low frame drum; distant bells; water drip.

large24 One-Page Reference

tem Acts: Hall Defense → Fen Recon → Warrens Assault/Parley. tem Key Tags: Mistwise • Shallow Draft • River-Runner • Reedslip • Drowse. tem SB Menu (Mist Iron): Hidden Shoal • Tower Fire • Oarline Breaks • Witness at Cliff •

Saga Twisted. tem Wilderness SB: Unwelcome Smoke • Bad Footing • Foul Water.
 tem Timers: Beacon Silence • Missing Boats • Brood-Matron's Rite • Hall Panic •
 Feud (Tollmen) • Oath Debts. tem Outcomes: Matron struck • Vents collapsed •
 Oaths proven. tem Advancement: Repute shift • Standing gained • Strings banked.

large25 Changelog

v0.1 First pass: three-act structure, fronts/timers, scenes/venues, enemies, oaths thing, wilderness/river/psionic hooks, rewards, and a one-page reference.

End of v0.1

large26 The Faith of the Linn: Shrine, Temple, and the Weight of the Word

The old gods ask for oaths. The new god asks for silence. I am not sure which is harder to give. Skald Aud of the Broken Keel, at the Thing of Stenskar, 847 AR

26.1 The Old Shrines: Oath, Tide, and Hearth

Before the Temple of Light sent its first missionaries across the Dolmis, before the Thepyrgosi Synod codified its doctrines, the Linn kept faith with powers who asked for no prayersonly *witness*. The old shrines are not buildings. They are **places of memory**: a sea-stack where a chieftain swore to return, a hearthstone where a foster-child was named, a cairn where a drowned crew was given to Vélki's tide.

sectionThe Patrons of the Shrines

The Linn do not have a pantheon. They have **oath-kin** powers who are addressed only when a debt is owed or a word must be sealed.

tem[Hrævkn (the Frost-Raven)] Witness of the Thing, whose ravens perch on the gables of every moot-hall. He does not speak; he *counts*. Every oath sworn on the oath-ring adds a feather to his tally. Every broken vow feathers his nest for winter.
 tem[Vélki (the Wave-Sworn)] She who was the first to bleed into the tide and drown. She sits on a throne of whalebone in the Abderrin Trench. When a Linn dies at sea, her hand rises through the waves to pull the body down not in malice, but in *collection*. The sea gives passage; the sea takes its price. tem[Skáldyr (the Boast-Eater)] A shape

that lives in the pause before the punchline, the tension of a harp string held too long. He feeds on *public promises*. A boast made before witnesses is a prayer. A boast broken leaves the boaster with a mouth full of ash. tem[Iarnvöllr (the Iron-Field)] Not a being but a *place*: a phantom battlefield that appears at dawn where the unburied dead of old raids walk in silent formation. They seek oaths, not blood. A living Linn who swears to retrieve a fallen comrade's weapon may pass through the Iron-Field unharmed. One who breaks that oath joins the march. tem[Hvítbjörn (the White Bear)] A great winter-walker who tests hospitality. He appears during the first blizzard, shaking snow from his fur at the door of a longhouse. If the household offers the first cup of mead, he stays until spring, keeping wolves from the fold. If they refuse, he leaves, and no guest will arrive until the thaw.

These are not gods to be worshipped. They are **creditors**. A Linn does not pray to Vélki for safe passage; she makes a *vow* to return a third of her plunder to the deep. A Linn does not ask Hraevkn for wisdom; he swears a *boast* before the Thing and trusts that the raven is counting.

At the table: Shrine-devout Linn (Devotion 2 or 3) gain **+1d** on rites or diplomacy conducted at a recognized shrine (a sea-stack, a moot-ring, a hearthstone). However, they begin social scenes in Temple-controlled venues at **Position 1**, as southern clerics eye them with suspicion.

26.2 The Temple of Light: The Southern Doctrine

The Temple of Light arrived not with armies but with **scribes, bells, and ledgers**. Thepyrgosi missionaries first came to the Linn coast during the reign of the Sea-Queen Hella Ironside, offering grain in exchange for permission to build a single chapel at Fairport. Within a generation, the Temple had established scriptoria, synod courts, and a network of **bell-towers** that marked time in the southern fashion: eight bells for Lauds, nine for the Angelus, a counting that still troubles Linn elders.

section What the Temple Teaches

The Temple of Light preaches a unified cosmology: one source of illumination, one hierarchy of saints and confessors, one law written in scripture rather than sworn on iron. Its priests carry **candles of witness**, not oath-rings. Confession is private, not public. Salvation is a matter of *grace*, not *interest*.

To a Linn ear, this sounds like a debt that can never be paid because no price is named.

Yet the Temple has spread for three reasons:

tem **Grain.** Linn winters are long. Temple granaries, stocked with southern grain, have saved villages from famine and those villages now ring the Angelus. tem **Law.** The Temple's canon law offers a way to *end* feuds, not merely suspend them. A blood-price can be paid to the Temple's poor fund, not to a rival clan. For Linn exhausted by generations of killing, this is seductive. tem **Writing.** The old faith is oral. Oaths are remembered, not recorded. The Temple offers *indulgences* parchment receipts for confessed sins, admissible in any synod court. To a culture that tracks strings and favors with knotted cords, a written receipt feels like *technology*.

At the table: Temple-devout Linn (Devotion +2 or +3) gain +1d on rites conducted in a consecrated church or on social rolls within a Temple-friendly venue. However, they begin scenes in shrine-controlled strongholds (cliff shrines, moot-rings, ancestral cairns) at **Position 1**, and any boast made before witnesses suffers 1d unless they ritually "convert" it into a written petition.

26.3 The Devotion Spectrum: Five Faces of Linn Faith

Most Linn do not sit at either extreme. They shift with the season, the harvest, and the proximity of a Temple granary. The **Devotion Spectrum** tracks this tension mechanically (see §25.1), but the *fiction* of each band is what brings the world to life.

section3: ShrineDevout (Pure Shrine)

"The raven knows my name. Does your god know yours?"

These Linn keep to the old ways. They swear oaths on iron rings, not parchment. They leave offerings of blood-silver at sea-stacks for Vélki. They refuse Temple grain even in famine. In shrines, they speak with the authority of generations. In Temple courts, they are sullen, evasive, and dangerous.

Typical communities: remote fjord villages, skerry-dwelling fishers, clans with a long feud history (they trust no outside law).

section2: ShrineLeaning

"The old ways are hard. But they are our ways."

These Linn honor the shrine patrons but will trade with Temple merchants. They attend Thing, not synod. They may send a child to a Temple school for writing lessons but the child must still swear a first oath on the family's oath-ring. They are the **backbone of resistance** to full conversion.

Typical communities: mixed coastal towns with a Thing-hall but also a Temple chapel; clans that have intermarried with southern families but kept their own hearth-traditions.

section1 to +1: Mixed / Unsure (The BridgeWalkers)

"I pour for the raven and kneel for the candle. Both have fed my children."

Most Linn live here. They will swear an oath at the Thing and also confess to a Temple priest different debts, different creditors. They name their children with old shrine-names (Wave-Sworn, Raven-Counted) but also give them Temple baptismal names. They are **pragmatic, not devout**. The spectrum moves for them only when a crisis forces a choice: a failed harvest blamed on neglected shrines, or a plague that Temple healers cannot cure.

Bridge-Walkers (Devotion 0) have no innate mechanical edge but may qualify for **Ambassador Status** (see §25.1) and are the most likely to earn **Synthesis Tokens** for blending practices.

section+2: TempleLeaning

"The ledger is clearer than the memory. I know what I owe."

These Linn have largely converted to the Temple of Light. They attend synod courts, not Things. They keep written accounts of debts and favors strings replaced by parchment. They may still visit a shrine on feast days, but they do so *quietly*, lest their Temple neighbors see. They are often wealthier than their shrine-devout kin, because Temple trade networks reach farther.

Typical communities: port towns with regular southern shipping, mercenary companies that fought for Thepyrgos or Ecktoria, families that lost a feud and used Temple arbitration to end it.

section+3: Pure Temple

"The old gods take. The Light gives."

These Linn have fully abandoned the shrines. They see the old patrons as demons or delusions. They are zealous, often converts of the second generation. They serve as Temple missionaries, judges, and scribes. In shrine-controlled villages, they may be met with cold silence or violence. They are the shock troops of the **Northern Crusade** and they are hated by many of their own kin.

Typical communities: Temple school graduates, families that were dispossessed by feud and found refuge in Temple lands, urban Linn in southern cities like Fairport or Thepyrgos itself.

26.4 The Northern Crusade: How the Temple of Light Presses North

The Temple of Light does not send armies. It sends **famine, law, and literacy** and when those fail, it sends **justiciars with bells**.

sectionStage One: The Grain Mission

Temple missionaries arrive in a lean winter with shiploads of southern grain. They offer it freely, no strings except a small chapel built by spring, a bell tower that marks the hours, a scribe who will write letters for those who cannot write. The first converts are the hungry and the curious.

sectionStage Two: The Synod Court

Once a Temple chapel is established, the bishop appoints a **synod judge**. This judge hears disputes that would normally go to the Thing. The judge uses canon law, which is written, consistent, and *slow*. For clans exhausted by blood-feud, this slow justice feels like mercy. For the shrine-devout, it feels like theft of their lawful authority.

The synod judge also hears *confessions*. A Linn who confesses a broken oath to the Temple is not required to pay blood-silver only to perform penance: a pilgrimage, a donation, a prayer. This undermines the entire shrine economy, which runs on compensation, not absolution.

sectionStage Three: The School

Where there is a synod court, there is a school. Children learn to read the Temple's script, to count in the southern fashion (eight bells to Lauds, nine to the Angelus), to write their names in ledgers. The schoolmaster is also a missionary. He does not destroy the old stories; he *rewrites* them. Hraevkn becomes a demon. Vélki becomes a cautionary tale about the perils of sea-worship. The White Bear becomes a metaphor for Christ's hospitality.

sectionStage Four: The Bell and the Banner

When a village has a chapel, a synod court, and a school, the Temple raises a **bell-tower** with a bronze bell cast in Thepyrgos. It rings eight times each morning. The old shrine bells iron, cracked, tuned to the older counting fall silent. The Temple also sends a **banner**: a white field with a golden candle, to be flown on feast days. In some villages, the shrine banner (a raven, a white bear, a wave) is relegated to a back wall. In others, it is burned.

The Northern Crusade is not a single war but a *process*. GMs can track it with a **Temple Pressure [6]** timer in a region. Each tick represents a new chapel, a synod court, a school, a bell-tower. When the timer fills, the region becomes Temple-controlled

(venue tags shift to Temple District or Contested Ground). Player actions can tick the timer backward by restoring a shrine, exposing a corrupt synod judge, or leading a successful raid against a Temple granary.

26.5 The Faith Tensions in Play: Example Scenes

sectionScene: The Thing at Winter Hearth

The Thing convenes to settle a feud. The shrine-devout demand blood-silver paid in iron and cattle. The Temple-leaning faction proposes synod arbitration: the feud is confessed, penance assigned, the matter closed. The jarl, a Bridge-Walker (Devotion 0), must choose. The GM sets a **Faith Tension** of Medium (rumors, side-eyes, low-level feuds). Faith-marked actions suffer 1 Position.

Player options:

- tem Side with the shrine-devout and gain a **String** (*Feud Token*) with that clan.
- tem Side with the Temple and gain a **String** (*Synod Indulgence*) with the bishop.
- tem Attempt a **syncretic resolution**: blood-silver paid to the Temple's poor fund, followed by a shrine blessing. This requires a **Synthesis Token** (see §25.1) or a hard roll.

sectionScene: The Bishop's Progress

A Temple bishop tours the coastal villages, consecrating new chapels. At each stop, he offers grain and scripture. Shrine-devout elders see their influence wane. The GM assigns a **Contested Ground** venue tag: both sides suffer 1 Position on faith actions unless they can frame their approach as bridge-building.

Player hook: A shrine-devout skald asks the party to steal the bishop's *bell-clappera* relic said to contain a fragment of the True Candle. Without it, the consecration cannot proceed. The party must infiltrate the bishop's camp, avoid his Thepyrgosi guards, and escape across the frozen fjord.

sectionScene: The Convert's Shame

A Temple-leaning Linn has agreed to testify against her own clan in a synod court, accusing them of "idolatry" (shrine worship). Her shrine-devout kin have declared a feud. She is now trapped in the Temple compound, afraid to leave.

Player options:

- tem Smuggle her to a neutral port (escort mission, uses River-Runner or Mistwise tags).
- tem Convince the synod judge to drop the case (social scene, requires **Belief**

Flexibility or Ambassador Status). tem Help her perform a **dual-oath** (shrine and Temple together) that satisfies both sides, earning a **Synthesis Token** and potentially creating a new syncretic traditionbut marking her as a heretic to both extremists.

26.6 Cross-Cultural Resonance: The Deep Threads

The Linn faith does not exist in isolation. Its shapes echo in other cultures across Fate's Edgenot because of borrowing, but because certain *structures of obligation* recur wherever people face the sea, the winter, and the problem of keeping promises.

sectionThe Thepyrgosi Thread (Syllogistic Theology)

The Temple of Light's canon law shares a deep structure with the **Thepyrgosi syllogism**: if A owes B, and B owes C, then A owes C. This is simple debt transfer. The Linn old faith holds a different logic: if A swears an oath to B, and B witnesses A's boast, then *B becomes part of the debta* tripartite structure (debtor, creditor, witness) that Thepyrgosi scholastics find inefficient.

In play: Thepyrgosi clerics attempting to convert Linn often stumble over the witness requirement. "Why does the raven need to know?" they ask. "Because the raven *is* the memory," the Linn reply.

sectionThe Dhaharan Thread (Mandala of Exchange)

The Dhaharan principalities, far to the south, have no shrines to ravens or white bears. But their **mandala of exchange**the idea that all transactions, spiritual and material, are mirrored across a cosmic ledgermaps cleanly onto the Linn understanding of Vélki's tide-debt. A Dhaharan merchant would recognize Vélki immediately: she is a *karmic creditor*, no different from a temple accountant.

In play: A Dhaharan trader who understands the Linn faith can negotiate blood-silver using Dhaharan ledger principles. This creates a **Bridge-Walker** moment (Devotion 0) where two very different cultures find a shared language of debt.

sectionThe Aeler Thread (Keystone and Oath)

The Aeler, those mountain engineers, keep their own faith in **keystone clauses**promises carved in stone, witnessed by bells, enforced by gravity. An Aeler tunnel-wright would find the Linn oath-ring perfectly legible: it is a *load-bearing promise*, a contract signed in breath rather than chisel.

In play: An Aeler Runekeeper serving a Linn crew may interpret their boasts as Rites, marking Obligation to Hraevkn rather than to a Patron. This is not conversion; it is

translation. The GM may allow such a character to use **Synthesis Tokens** to blend Linn shrine rites with Aeler ledgers.

26.7 Faith, Saga, and the Shape of a Life

The Saga System (§26) is the perfect engine for tracking a Linn's faith journey. A character's Devotion should move rarely only at major story beats:

tem **Shrine-Devout (3) to Mixed (1)**: After surviving a winter on Temple grain, a Linn may lose faith in the old ways. Mechanically, this is a **Story-Shaping Decision** worth 12 Saga Points. tem **Mixed (0) to Temple-Leaning (+2)**: After a synod court ends a blood-feud that had lasted three generations, a clan may convert en masse. This is a **Legendary Deed** (Oath-Keeper Supreme) and may grant a permanent **Syncretic Tradition** boon. tem **Temple-Leaning (+2) to Pure Temple (+3)**: A character becomes a missionary, a justiciar, a bell-caster. They gain the **Belief Flexibility** talent (4 XP) for free but they also gain a **Heretic** tag in shrine-devout venues.

section Saga Scenes of Faith

When a player declares a **Saga Scene** (§26.5) in a faith context, the spotlight should illuminate the *cost* of belief:

tem A shrine-devout skald sings the old names in a Temple chapel (Position +1 for the first roll, but the GM may spend 1 SB to have a synod judge arrive mid-verse). tem A Temple-leaning justiciar pronounces a shrine a demon-house and orders it burned. She gains +1d on her Command roll, but her shadow now has a raven's silhouette (a Saga Scar, usable by the GM for future complications). tem A Bridge-Walker mediates between a shrine-devout clan and a Temple bishop. She earns a **Synthesis Token** immediately, but both sides demand a *reciprocal oath* and she is now the witness.

26.8 The Ninth Bell and the Unfinished Count

The Temple of Light rings nine bells to mark the Angelus. The old shrines ring eight and stop. This is not an accident. The **Ninth Bell** is the one that opens the door to the Hollow, to the Iron-Field, to the space where debts are not paid but *forgotten*.

In Linn belief, the Temple's ninth bell is not a prayer. It is a *threat*. It says: *you owe more than you can count*. The old faith answers: *then count to eight, and stop*. *The ninth is not for you*.

GM seed: A Temple bell-tower in a recently converted village begins ringing a ninth bell at midnight. Livestock sicken. Children walk in their sleep toward the sea. The shrine-devout say the old patrons are angry. The Temple says the devil is testing the faithful. The truth is simpler: the bell was cast from iron salvaged from a ship that sank without burial. The drowned are counting.

The old gods count your breaths. The new god counts your sins. Neither will let you forget. The question is which ledger you would rather read at midnight. Dusana of the Raven Road, at the Thing of Stenskar, after the ninth bell fell silent

26.9 Temple of Light, Shrines, and the Devotion Spectrum

labelsec:templedevotion dexTemple of Lightdexshrinesdexdevotion spectrum

The Temple of Light and the old shrine cults do not exist as a simple on/off switch. Most Linn live somewhere along a sliding scale of tradition and new faith. Rather than tracking separate factions in detail, use the following lightweight overlays on existing mechanics (Position, SB, Tags, and Conditions).

section*The Devotion Spectrum dexdevotion spectrum

Each character (or crew, if you prefer) may mark a single **Devotion value** from 3 to +3:

3 ß 2 ß 1 ß 0 ß +1 ß +2 ß +3

tem 3: **Pure Shrine** openly devoted to patrons, deeply suspicious of Temple. tem 1 to +1: **Mixed / Unsure** lives in both worlds, or keeps faith private. tem +3: **Pure Temple** openly devout; treats shrines as questionable or obsolete.

When It Moves

tem Only move Devotion on **major story beats**: public conversions, dramatic repudiations of a faith, founding or closing a shrine/Temple, or major miracles. tem A quiet personal doubt is color; a public oathbreaking before a hall can shift the track.

Mechanical Edge (Extremes Only) Devotion only has direct mechanical teeth at:

tem 2 or 3: **ShrineFavored** gain +1d on patron rites or shrine diplomacy; suffer 1 Position in clearly Templedominated venues. tem 0: **BridgeWalker** no innate bonus, but can qualify for *Ambassador Status* (below). tem +2 or +3: **TempleFavored** gain +1d on Temple rites or Temple court scenes; suffer 1 Position in shrine strongholds.

section*Venue Tags FaithBased Position dexvenue tagsdexPosition!faithbased

Instead of detailed faction sheets, give each important location a single **faith tag**:

tem **Shrine Stronghold** hills, halls, or villages bound tightly to patrons. tem **Temple District** towns with active Temple of Light presence and law. tem **Mixed Quarter** places where both altars stand; everyday compromise. tem **Contested Ground** frontiers, halls, or thingsites where both sides push.

Apply simple Position modifiers:

tem **ShrineFriendly Venue**: Templeleaning characters (+2/ +3) suffer 1 Position on overtly faithbased actions unless they show respect or humility. tem **Temple-Friendly Venue**: Shrineleaning characters (2/3) suffer 1 Position on faith actions unless they submit to Temple forms. tem **Mixed Quarter**: No automatic penalty; GM may assess 1 Position for open grandstanding by either extreme. tem **Contested Ground**: Both sides suffer 1 Position on faith actions *unless* they can frame their approach as **bridgebuilding**. The GM may spend 1 **SB** to create a brief opening where a sincere mediator can act at neutral Position.

section*Faith Tension as a Scene Tag dexfaith tension

Treat religious tension like weather or terrain: a **scenelevel tag** that sits on top of everything else.

tem[Low Tension] Everyday life. No special modifiers. tem[Medium Tension] Rumors, sideeyes, lowlevel feuds. *Faithmarked* actions (invoking shrines, Temple doctrine, public prayers) suffer 1 Position. tem[High Tension] Open feuding, recent blasphemy, or fresh Temple decrees. Opposingfaith interactions take DV + 1 and generate automatic **Exposure +1** on failure.

The GM can adjust Faith Tension up or down when:

tem A public slight, miracle, or atrocity occurs. tem A Saga Scene (§??) plays out around faith.

section*Synthesis Tokens: Blending Practices dexSynthesis Tokendexsyncretism

When characters successfully blend shrine and Temple practices in a scene *and* the table agrees it feels earned (shared prayers, joint rites, dual oath funerals):

tem The crew gains a **Synthesis Token** (treat like a *Boon* that can only be spent in faith contexts).

A Synthesis Token may be spent to:

tem Improve Position by one step for a faithbased action (e.g. ControlledβControlled).
 tem Gain +1d on diplomacy between Temple and shrine factions. tem Declare **temporary safe passage** through otherwise hostile religious territory for a single scene (guards stand aside, elders agree to host, etc.).

Unused Tokens do not stack endlessly; the crew may hold at most **two** Synthesis Tokens at a time.

section*Dual Oaths Spiritual Conflict dexdual oathsdexConditions!Spiritual Conflict

Some characters swear both to a patron shrine and the Temple of Light.

You do not need a separate timer; instead, when you roll for a clearly faithmarked action while holding **both** shrine oath and Temple vow:

tem If the roll shows one or more **1s**, you must **choose** which faith is offended by how you acted. tem The offended side gains a narrative opening: colder reactions, whispers, or calls to prove yourself later.

If you refuse to choose:

tem Mark the **Spiritual Conflict** Condition: *“Pulled Between Altars”* (1 die to faith actions until resolved). tem Resolve it by taking a clear, public stand in a dramatic scene: favor one faith, attempt a risky synthesis, or refuse both and accept the fallout.

section*Ritual Adaptation Contamination dexritual adaptationdexContamination token

When you perform shrine rites in explicitly Temple spaces (or Temple rites in fiercely shrineheld space), you are stepping into dangerous territory.

GM SB Use (Ritual Adaptation) When characters attempt mixed rites:

tem **1 SB**: Minor offense (wrong tool, clumsy phrasing) social awkwardness, hushed whispers. tem **2 SB**: Moderate tension rumors, open criticism, minor feud Timers tick. tem **3+ SB**: Major conflict accusations of blasphemy, forced choices, or legal challenges.

Contamination Tokens Additionally, if the rite is clearly “in the wrong place,” the GM may mark a **Contamination Token** on the character or venue:

tem While holding a Contamination Token, you suffer 1 die to *all* faithbased rolls linked to that space or rite. tem Clear a Token by:tem Spending part of downtime on cleansing rites, reparations, or pilgrimages; or tem Converting it into growth: treat 1 Token as **1 XP** toward a faithaligned talent or Devotion shift (you learned from your mistake, in public).

section*Faith Ambassadors Flexible Belief dexAmbassador StatusdexBelief Flexibility
Some characters become known as bridgebuilders, mediators, or “those who can speak to both altars”.

Ambassador Status A character who has *successfully* mediated at least two serious faith conflicts (GM judgment) may be granted **Ambassador Status**:

tem Mark a single checkbox or tag: *TempleShrine Ambassador*. tem Once per session, convert a *faithbased Position penalty* (e.g. from venue or Devotion) into an equivalent **bonus** for a single roll (e.g. Controlled β Controlled), by explicitly leaning on their reputation as a neutral voice. tem Refresh Ambassador Status when you play out another mediation scene that matters.

Optional Talent: Belief Flexibility For characters who intentionally walk the line, you can allow a minor talent:

tem[**Belief Flexibility** (4 XP)] Once per session, ignore faithalignment Position penalties (from venue tags or Devotion) for a single scene, representing a knack for “reading the room” and speaking both languages.

Limit: You cannot benefit from both shrine *and* Templespecific mechanical advantages in the same scene (pick which side of your faith is active).

section*Using Faith in Play dexfaith!at the table

tem **Keep It Light** These tools hang off mechanics you already use (Position, SB, Tags, Conditions). If you are ever tracking more than Devotion, one venue tag, and maybe a Token or two, simplify. tem **Play For Drama** Use Devotion shifts and Synthesis Tokens to spotlight big, meaningful choices, not background noise. tem **Tie Into Saga** Faith choices make excellent fuel for the Saga system (§??): conversions, heresy trials, shrine restorations, and Temple victories are all things skalds love to sing about.

large27 Saga System: Epic Reputation and Legendary Deeds

labelsec:sagasystem dexSaga Reputationdexreputation!sagadexlegendary deeds

Not every story told in smokefilled halls is true, but the ones that *stick* shape how the world meets you. The Saga System tracks not only what your crew has done, but how those deeds are remembered, twisted, and invoked by others.

Saga Reputation sits alongside personal **Repute**, **Audience** tags, and **Oaths**. Where those mark who knows you locally, Saga Reputation marks when your story starts to move on its own.

27.1 Crew Saga Reputation Track

dexSaga Reputation!track

Each crew maintains a shared **Saga Reputation** track [6] that grows as they perform legendary deeds. This track represents how their exploits are told in halls across the northern lands.

tem **Saga 12: Local Tales** Known by name in nearby settlements; a few skalds are watching your story. tem **Saga 34: Regional Fame** Songs and verses carry your deeds along trade routes and fjords; strangers recognize you by deeds, if not by face. tem **Saga 56: Living Legend** Your name is invoked in boasts, oaths, and threats. Children play at being you. Enemies plan around you.

Who Tracks It? Saga Reputation is *crewlevel*, not individual. Different characters may be more or less central to specific stories, but the world tends to remember “the crew” or

“the Linn from the Mistship” as a whole.

27.2 Earning Saga Points

dexSaga Reputation!earning

You raise Saga Reputation by earning **Saga Points**. Mark 12 Saga Points when the crew does something that people will *actually talk about* later.

Core Triggers

tem **Epic Victories** Defeating foes significantly above your Tier or overturning a seemingly unwinnable situation (e.g. defending a hall against impossible odds). tem **Impossible Feats** Succeeding at DV 5+ Position tests where the table agrees “this is the kind of thing skalds brag about”. tem **HonorKeeping** Fulfilling major oaths under extreme circumstances, especially when keeping the oath costs you dearly. tem **Legendary Sacrifices** Choosing the harder path for the greater good: voluntary maiming, loss of wealth, exile, or similar stakes. tem **StoryShaping Decisions** A choice that permanently alters a hall, village, route, or region (toppling a jarl, ending a feud, founding a Temple or shrine).

GM Guidance

tem *Ask*: “Would someone in three winters still be telling this story at a thing?” If yes, award Saga Points. 0 tem *Scale*: 1 Saga Point for strong deeds; 2 for true legends that also change fronts or timers on the campaign map.

Each time the Saga track fills [6/6], clear it and advance the crew’s **Saga Tier** by 1 (step their Saga Reputation band up to the next level). Optionally record a short *Saga Line* in the crew sheet: a onesentence summary skalds repeat.

27.3 Saga Benefits: Position Social Edge

dexPosition!Saga benefits

As Saga Reputation increases, the crew gains powerful Position and advantage benefits that reflect how the world receives them.

Saga 12: Local Heroes

tem[**Local Hero**] Once per scene, when *defending your home, kin, or named allies*, one PC may improve Position by one step (DesperateßControlled or ControlledßControlled) on a single roll.

Saga 34: Regional Champions

tem[**Regional Champion**] Once per session, a PC may declare a specific past deed (“*We held the bridge at Stormfjord for three days*”) that is now widely known. With GM approval, they gain +1d to a single roll where that story logically applies (rallying defenders, intimidating raiders, convincing a jarl to trust them, etc.).

Saga 56: Living Legends

tem[**Legendary Warrior**] Once per session, when the crew acts in a hall or region where their legend is wellknown, one PC may treat any *Controlled* Position as *Dominant* for a single action, reflecting that the world *expects* them to triumph.

Optional: Individual Saga Marks Individual PCs can also record **Saga Marks** for personally famous deeds (see ??), but these are color until the GM calls on them for Position shifts, Audience tags, or Strings.

27.4 Saga Complications: Fame as a Knife

dexSaga Reputation!complications

Saga Reputation is a doubleedged axe. Fame brings attention, expectations, and enemies.

tem **Rival Challenges** At higher Saga levels, the GM is encouraged to introduce rival crews, warriors, or Temple champions who seek glory by besting you. For each Saga Tier above 2, once per arc start a **Rival Challenge [4]** timer. tem **Expectation Burden** Audience tags tilt toward “*expectsimpossiblefeats*”. Failures in public scenes may tick additional fallout timers as people feel *betrayed*, not merely disappointed. tem **Target Status** Enemies who come specifically hunting the famous crew gain +1d to *Assess*, *Track*, or *Ambush* rolls against them; their scouts already know your tactics and tales. tem **Saga Debt** The GM may introduce **Saga Debt**

complications: a hall that sheltered you now calls in a favor, a child you inspired has gone missing hunting glory, or someone lied using your name.

As a rule of thumb, for each Saga Tier above 1, allow the GM to add one additional twist or String per session based on fame alone.

27.5 Saga Scenes: Fame Arrives Before You Do

dexSaga scenes

When the crew's Saga Reputation is **3+**, once per session a player may declare a **Saga Scene**.

tem Set the scene in a location where your fame plausibly precedes you: a coastal hall, a tradetown, a Temple court that follows skald verse. tem The active PC begins with **Position +1** on their first significant social interaction (e.g. Controlled instead of Controlled). tem All allies in the scene gain **+1d once** when they explicitly invoke the crew's legend (quoting a verse, showing a trophy, calling on a past deed). tem The scene must showcase the crew's legendary nature in some way: public boast, challenge, judgment, or sacrifice. If it resolves quietly, the GM may rule that no new Saga Points are earned from it.

Saga Scenes are a spotlight tool: use them to turn ordinary negotiations or meetings into memorable chapters in the crew's story.

27.6 Legendary Deeds Personal Boons

labelsec:legendarydeeds dexlegendary deedsdexboons!saga

Certain deeds are so monumental that they grant permanent, personal benefits in addition to Saga Points. These should be *rare*, negotiated moments, not routine rewards.

tem[**Slayer of Beasts**] Defeat a creature of myth or a unique monster that has haunted a hall, route, or region for generations. Gain **+1d** on all future rolls directly confronting similar creatures or their kin. tem[**OathKeeper Supreme**] Fulfill an "impossible" oath that multiple NPCs declared unachievable (e.g. "end this bloodfeud in a single winter", "bring both shrine and Temple to the same altar"). Once per session, convert one *single failed* roll related to oath, duty, or honor into a success at *limited* Effect (mark 1 SB as cost). tem[**Shield of the Innocent**] Defend the defenseless against overwhelming odds in a public, widelywitnessed stand. Gain **+1**

Armor (nonstacking) when you explicitly protect others, even without a physical shield. tem **[Master of Elements]** Survive an impossible natural force (shipwreck, avalanche, volcanic ash, stormice) in a way that becomes a hallstory. Gain permanent **resistance** to one chosen environmental hazard (e.g. cold, storm, fire, sea).

Saga Scars Optionally, pair each Legendary Deed with a **Saga Scar**: a visible mark, habit, or quirk that signals the deed and may impose small costs (difficulty sleeping in calm weather, reflexive shielding behavior, faint frostbite, etc.). These are narrative prompts the GM can tag for SB spends.

27.7 Saga Decline Fallen Heroes

dexSaga Reputation!declinedexFallen Hero

Saga Reputation is not guaranteed. It can decline when your story curdles.

Loss Triggers

tem **OathBreaking** Publicly failing to keep a major oath, especially one bound before many witnesses or under shrine/Temple. tem **Cowardice** Refusing to act when honor or duty clearly demands it, and others see this choice. tem **Betrayal** Turning against guests, sworn allies, or those under your protection. tem **Hubris** Actions that show dangerous overconfidence leading to tragic fallout (e.g. provoking needless war, squandering hardwon peace).

When one of these occurs in a public way, the GM may:

tem Reduce Saga Reputation by 1 step (e.g. from 4 to 3). tem Strip one Saga Benefit (e.g. you no longer count as *Regional Champion*). tem Introduce a **Fallen Hero** Complication: former allies become rivals, children who idolized you turn bitter, or a skald begins composing a mocking countersaga.

Redemption Arcs

Falling does not have to be the end:

tem Create a **Redemption Saga** [6] timer. When it fills through selfsacrifice, amends, or impossible tasks, you may regain lost Saga steps or transform your legend into a new shape: *the Penitent*, *the OathRestorer*, etc.

27.8 Integration with Temple of Light Shrines

dexTemple of Light!Sagadexshrines!Saga

Religious choice is part of your legend. Whether you stand with shrines, the Temple of Light, or both, the songs will say something about it.

TempleForward Sagas

tem **Temple Conversion** When the crew openly converts to the Temple of Light and champions its causes, they may earn Saga Points for:tem Founding a new Temple or saving an existing one from ruin. tem Ending a Faith Feud through Temple law and mercy. tem Converting a powerful hall, jarl, or famed shrinekeeper.

tem Mechanically, treat these as *StoryShaping Decisions*. However, shrinedevout Audiences may assign negative tags (*OathTurners*, *TemplePawns*) and reduce certain Saga Benefits when dealing with traditionalists.

ShrineDevout Sagas

tem Crews who visibly champion shrines against Temple expansion may gain extra Saga Points for:tem Restoring a desecrated shrine to power. tem Driving out abusive Temple agents without collapsing law. tem Crafting syncretic rites that keep old powers honored.

tem Temple Audiences may see them as *heretics* or *obstinate pagans*, increasing DV or lowering starting Position in Temple courts.

Syncretic Sagas

tem **Syncretic Path** Some crews walk between: swearing shrineoaths while bearing Temple blessings. Their Saga tends to be *contested*. tem Mechanically, they may earn Saga Points for brokering peace between faiths or inventing new shared rites, but:tem Start certain faith scenes with **mixed Audience tags** (*Curious*, *Suspicious*, *Conflicted*). tem The GM may tick **Dual Oath Conflict** or **Faith Feud** timers whenever a syncretic act goes badly.

Heretic Legends

tem[**Heretic Status**] If the crew openly defies Temple doctrine *and* shrine agreements (e.g. consorting with banned powers, profaning both altars), their Saga might shift into a darker mode:tem Temple and shrine both gain license to hunt them; enemies gain +1d to find religious allies. tem At the same time, desperate halls, outcasts, and hidden cults might invoke them as *necessary monsters* or *stormbringers*, granting unusual aid. tem Treat them as *Legendary Adversaries* in some stories, *secret saints* in others; Position swings can be dramatic.

27.9 Using Saga at the Table

dexSaga system!table use

tem **For Players:** Think of Saga as the camera pulling back. When you chase Saga Points, you are choosing which scenes become the ones future characters will hear about. tem **For GMs:** Use Saga Reputation to choose who has heard of the crew, who cares, and how strongly. Let it steer front creation, rival crews, and which NPCs show up asking for help or vengeance. tem **For the Campaign:** Over time, the Saga System can track the arc from unknown raiders to hallbuilders, faithchampions, outcast heretics, or founders of a new order. Decide together which saga you are writing.

largeA Faith Tags for Linn Venues

largeB Glossary of Nordic Terms

B.1 Social and Political Terms

tem[Aett] A clan or family grouping, often tracing descent from a common ancestor. The basic social unit in Linn society. tem[Bloodsilver] Compensation paid to settle disputes and avoid feuds. A monetary or material payment that satisfies honor without violence. tem[Boast] A public declaration of intended action, creating social obligation. Failure to fulfill a boast damages reputation and may start feuds. tem[Feud] An ongoing conflict between families or crews, tracked mechanically. Allows for escalation and resolution through various means. tem[Lawspeaker] Traditional role at Things who memorizes and recites the law. Could be incorporated as

	line	Venue	Text	Field	Mechanica
	line	A sea-stack shrine (Vélki)		Shrine	Temple-devotion
				Stronghold	
				ac-	
				ters	
				suf-	
				fer	
				1	
				Posi-	
				tion	
				on	
				faith	
				ac-	
				tions	
	line	A Thing-ring (Hrævkn)		Shrine	Temple-devotion
				Stronghold	
				also,	
				any	
				boast	
				made	
				here	
				is	
				wit-	
				nessed	
				(can-	
				not	
				be	
				re-	
				tracted)	
	line	A Temple chapel		Shrine	Temple-devotion
				Dischar-	
				triac-	
				ters	
				suf-	
				fer	
				1	
				Posi-	
				tion	
				on	
				faith	
				ac-	
				tions	
cering ewidth	line	A synod court		Temple	Temple
				Disabove;	
				trials,	
				any	
				writ-	
				ten	

a specialized crew role. tem[Repute] Social standing and honor within Linn society. Affects social interactions and access to opportunities. tem[Saga] Epic tales of heroic deeds that enhance reputation. Also represents the mechanical system for tracking legendary status. tem[Skald] A poetsinger who composes and performs verses about heroic deeds. Important for maintaining and spreading reputation. tem[String] A favor, connection, or obligation that can be called upon. Represents social capital and relationships. tem[Thing] Political assembly where laws are made, disputes settled, and oaths sworn. Winter gatherings for community decisionmaking. tem[Thinglet] Smaller, informal assembly for local matters, often held within a hall. tem[Wyrd] Fate or doom, often settled through ordeal or trial by combat when legal resolution fails.

B.2 Maritime and Travel Terms

tem[Beaching Hull] Ship design feature allowing vessels to land directly on shore for easy access and escape. tem[Broadshore] Cargo vessel type with higher freeboard and stouter construction, slower but more seaworthy than raiding ships. tem[Gare] Local term for fog or mist conditions, particularly those affecting navigation and visibility. tem[Longhull] Sleek raiding vessel with shallow draft and fast oars, designed for speed and beach landings. tem[Mistwise] Specialized knowledge of navigating in foggy conditions, a valuable crew skill. tem[Pilot Stone] Cairn or marker used for navigation in familiar waters, often moved to confuse rivals. tem[Riverspear] Light, narrow vessel designed for inland waterways, often with collapsible mast. tem[Shallow Draft] Ship design allowing navigation in waters too shallow for deeper vessels. tem[Skerry] Small rocky island or reef, often hazardous to navigation but useful for ambushes.

B.3 Cultural and Religious Terms

tem[Hospitable] Cultural value emphasizing the sacred duty to provide guestright and proper hospitality. tem[Muster] Spring gathering of crews and preparation for summer activities. tem[Oathbound] Character committed to keeping vows and promises, regardless of cost. tem[Riverwise] Specialized knowledge of river navigation, hazards, and local customs. tem[Shrine Warding] Ritual protection of settlements or territories through sacred sites and ceremonies. tem[WolfBanner] Warrior tradition or crew identity associated with fierce combat and boarding actions.

B.4 Seasonal Terms

tem[Hearth Time] Winter period of indoor activities, maintenance, and community bonding. tem[Muster] Spring assembly for preparation and crew organization. tem[Raids] Summer period of seaborne expeditions and military activities. tem[Settling] Autumn period for resolving disputes, trade negotiations, and harvest activities. tem[Thing Season] Winter period when assemblies are held due to weather and availability.

B.5 Combat and Conflict Terms

tem[Board Brace] Naval combat action involving boarding enemy vessels and fighting handtohand. tem[WolfBoarding Gear] Specialized equipment for shiptoship combat, including hooks, ropes, and boarding planks.